

JONATHAN ROBERT CERVAS

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ACADEMIC EMPLOYMENT

CARNEGIE MELLON UNIVERSITY

*Assistant Teaching Professor, 2024-
Post-Doctoral Fellow, 2020–2024*

EDUCATION

UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA, IRVINE

Ph.D., Political Science, 2020

Dissertation Committee: Bernard Grofman (Chair), Michael Tesler, Carole Uhlaner
Dissertation: *A Quantitative Assessment of the U.S. Electoral College, 1790–2020*
Fields: American Politics, Political Methodology, Comparative Politics

M.A., Political Science, December 2018

UNIVERSITY OF NEVADA, LAS VEGAS

B.A., Political Science, 2007

Major: Political Science
Confer: 05/12/2007
Degree GPA: 3.277

ADDITIONAL TRAINING

Workshop on Research Design for Causal Inference, *Northwestern University*, 2017
Inter-university Consortium for Political and Social Research (ICPSR), *University of Michigan*, 2016

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Special Master or Court-Appointed Expert

- Special Master, State of New York, Bath, NY. April 2022 - May 2022.
 - Appointed by the Supreme Court of New York to draw state's Congressional and State Senate Districts, pursuant to *Harkenrider v. Hochul*.
 - “Report of the Special Master”, available online.
- Court Consultant, State of Wisconsin, Madison, WI. January 2024 - September 2024.
 - Appointed by the Wisconsin Supreme Court to advise, and if necessary, redraw the state's legislative districts, pursuant to *Clarke v. Wisconsin Elections Commission*, No. 2023AP1399-OA, 2023 WI 79, 2024.
 - “Report of the Court-Appointed Co-Consultants”, available online.
- Assistant to the Special Master
 - *Wright v. Sumter County Board of Elections*, 2019–2020.
 - *Bethune-Hill v. Virginia State Board of Elections*, 2018–2019.
 - *Navajo Nation v. San Juan County, UT*, 2017.

Redistricting and Elections Consultant

- Redistricting Consultant, *Legislative Reapportionment Commission*, Harrisburg, PA. July 2021 - March 2022.
 - Appointed by the Pennsylvania Legislative Reapportionment Commission to advice and help draw the state's legislative districts.
 - Resolution Regarding Mapping Consultant Resolution 3a, available online.

Court Filings and Amicus Briefs

- “Memo in Support of Grofman/Cervas/Griggy Remedial Proposals,” U.S. District Court for the Northern District of Alabama, Southern Division, 2023 (with Bernard Grofman).
- “Brief of Amici Curiae in Support of Neither Party,” Fifth Judicial District Court, County of Lea, State of New Mexico, 2023 (with Paul Mitchell, Samuel S.-H. Wang, Roderick Kennedy, Election Reformers Network, Common Cause New Mexico, and the League of Women Voters New Mexico).
- “Brief of Amicus Curiae,” Maine ranked-choice voting, 2020 (with the Princeton Electoral Innovation Lab).

Expert Witness

- *Sherman v. Hargett* 26-cv-616
- *Driver v. Houston County* Civil Action No. 5:25-cv-25. Expert Report, Rebuttal Report
- *Wise v. State of Missouri* (2026) Case No. 2516-CV29597. Expert Report, Rebuttal Report
- *New York Communities for Change v. County of Nassau* (2025). Expert Report, Reply Report
- *Moore v. Lee*, Tennessee Chancery Court (2022). Reports [1](#), [2](#), [3](#), [4](#), [5](#).

Consultant

- New York State Board of Elections, Language Assistance (2025-2026)
- Town of Newburgh, NY (2024)
- Town of Cheektowaga, NY (2024)

RESEARCH INTERESTS

American Politics, Elections, Voting Rights, Public Opinion & Representation, Methodology.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

COURSES

- *Representation and Voting Rights* - 84-352/652 - (Spring 2021, Spring 2022, Spring 2023, Spring 2024, Spring 2026)
 - Dietrich General Education, *Perspectives on Justice and Injustice*
- *Introduction to US Constitutional Law* - 84-120 - (Spring 2026)
 - Dietrich General Education, *Humanities*
- *American Political Divides and Great Debates* - 84-309/609 - (Fall 2024, Fall 2025)
 - Dietrich General Education, *Perspectives on Justice and Injustice*
 - Eberly Center Consultation on Course Design and Early Semester Feedback (Patrick Welsh, 2024, 2025)
- Democracy's Data: Analytics and Insights into American Elections* - 84-355/655 - (Fall 2024, Fall 2025)

- Dietrich General Education, *Contextual Thinking*
- *Regression Analysis for Political Science II* - 84-702 - (Spring 2023, Spring 2024)
- Dietrich General Education, *Scientific Inquiry*
- *American Politics Graduate Seminar/Advanced Topics in American Politics* - 84-421/721 - (Fall 2020, Fall 2021, Fall 2022, Fall 2023)

GRANTS

- *Generative AI Teaching as Research Initiative: GAITAR@Scale* - American Political Divides and Great Debates (April 2025) - \$3,000

RESEARCH

PUBLICATIONS

My contributions in joint papers are typically the data construction, statistical and geographic analysis, and modeling. I contributed substantially to the writing, and on the law reviews, to legal research.

15. **“Partisan Gerrymandering.”** In *Elgar Encyclopedia of Public Choice*, edited by Richard Jong-A-Pin and Christian Bjørnskov (2025) (with Bernard Grofman).
14. **“Partisan Gerrymandering Cases in State Supreme Courts in the 2020s Redistricting Round.”** *Albany Law Review* 87, no. 4 (2024) (with Bernard Grofman, Scott Matsuda, and Justine Kawa).
13. **“Statistical Fallacies in Claims about ‘Massive and Widespread Fraud’ in the 2020 Presidential Election.”** *Statistics and Public Policy* 11, no. 1 (2023) (with Bernard Grofman).
12. **“The Role of State Courts in Constraining Partisan Gerrymandering in Congressional Elections.”** *University of New Hampshire Law Review* 21, no. 2 (2023): 421 (with Bernard Grofman and Scott Matsuda).
11. **“Using Folded Seats-Votes Curves to Compare Partisan Bias in the 2020 Presidential Election with Other 21st Century Elections.”** *Presidential Studies Quarterly* (2022) (with Bernard Grofman).
10. **“Why Donald Trump Should Be a Fervent Advocate of Using Ranked-Choice Voting in 2024.”** *PS: Political Science & Politics* 55, no. 1 (2022) (with Bernard Grofman).
9. **“Turning Communities of Interest into a Rigorous Standard for Fair Districting.”** *Stanford Journal of Civil Rights & Civil Liberties* 18 (2022): 101 (with Sam Wang, Sandra Chen, Richard Ober, Bernard Grofman, and Kyle Barnes).

8. **“A Systems Framework for Remedying Distortions in U.S. Democracy.”** *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences* 118, no. 50 (2021): e2102154118 (with Sam Wang, Bernard Grofman, and Keena Lipsitz).
7. **“The Unanticipated Effect of Covid-19 on House Apportionments.”** *Social Science Quarterly* 102, no. 5 (2021): 2432–2434 (with Bernard Grofman).
6. **“ZIP Codes as Geographic Bases of Representation.”** *Election Law Journal* (2021) (with Bernard Grofman).
5. **“Legal, Political Science and Economics Approaches to Measuring Malapportionment.”** *Social Science Quarterly* 101, no. 6 (2020): 2238–2256 (with Bernard Grofman).
4. **“Tools for Identifying Partisan Gerrymandering: Pennsylvania Case Study.”** *Political Geography* 76 (2020): 102069 (with Bernard Grofman).
3. **“Are Presidential Inversions Inevitable?”** *Social Science Quarterly* 100, no. 4 (2019): 1322–1342 (with Bernard Grofman).
2. **“Can State Courts Cure Partisan Gerrymandering? Lessons from *League of Women Voters v. Pennsylvania*.”** *Election Law Journal* 17, no. 4 (2018): 264–285 (with Bernard Grofman).
1. **“Why Noncompetitive States Matter: The Electoral College 1868–2016.”** *Public Choice* 173, no. 3–4 (2017): 251–265 (with Bernard Grofman).

Op-Eds and Public Commentary

- “The Effects of Mid-Decade Redistricting on Electoral Outcomes,”** *Medium*, 2025.
- “Trump the Wrestler and the 2024 Grudge Match,”** *Medium*, 2024 (with Bernard Grofman).
- “Fracking: A Contiguity-Related Redistricting Metric,”** *Election Law Blog*, 2021 (with Bernard Grofman).
- “The GOP Scared Latinos from the Census. Now That May Cost the Party Red Seats,”** *The Washington Post*, May 1, 2021 (with Sam Wang).
- “A More Equitable Voting System in Maine: Ranked-Choice Voting,”** *Medium (3Streams)*, 2021 (with Anjali Akula and Elsie Goren).
- “How Likely is Trump to Lose the Popular Vote but Win the Electoral College?”** *Medium (3Streams)*, 2020 (with Bernard Grofman).
- “These Are the Political Consequences of Excluding Undocumented Immigrants from Apportionment,”** *Medium (3Streams)*, 2020 (with Angela Ocampo).

“Pennsylvania Has to Draw New Congressional Districts but Getting Rid of Gerrymandering Will Be Harder Than You Think,” *The Washington Post*, February 9, 2018 (with Bernard Grofman).

Working Papers/Pipeline

- A Simple Algorithm for Good Government Districting: So Easy You Can Apply it by Hand
- A typology for forms of redistricting commissions w/ Hayden Goldberg
- Consequences of Choice of House Apportionment Method in 2020
- Constituency Diversity and Electoral Competitiveness In House and Senate Elections w/ Brunell
- Controversies and Complexities in Implementing “Good Government” Criteria for Redistricting in the 2020 Redistricting Round
- Determinants of Swing Ratio
- District Diversity and Electoral Competitiveness In House and Senate Elections, 1962-202x - - w/ Brunell
- Does Partisan Bias In The Electoral College Doom The Democrats In 2024
- Drop-off of Voters in the 2014 Midterm Election: Orphan States and Minority Withdrawal from the Electorate
- Estimating the Extent to which there is White Backlash to a Growing Hispanic Population that Generates Greater White Voter Support for Republican Candidates
- Examining Expert Witness Testimony in Redistricting Litigation - w/ Hayden Goldberg
- An Experiment on Optimal Campaigning Using a Simplified Seven State Electoral College
- Folded Seats-Votes Curves (was Simple Graphical Tool to Display Seats-Votes Relationship)w/ Nagle & Lederman
- Fracking: A Contiguity-Related Redistricting Metric (Splitting Geographies in the Context of Redistricting)
- How Certain was it that the Democrats would Lose Control of the House of Representatives in 2022? (renamed)
- Is the Electoral College Biased in Favor of Republicans? Yes and No and Maybe
- Optimal Partisan Gerrymandering Revisited - w/ Krieg
- Paths to Victory in Presidential Campaigns

- Political Polarization (Clarifying Concepts related to polarization)
- Population-Dependence of Cabinet Sizes - w/ Taagepera, Kaiser, (maybe Atsusaka)
- Predictable Elections, Ideological Constraint, and Stability in the 21st Century
- Predicting Divergence between the Popular Vote Winner and the Electoral College Winner, 1868-2016: The Dogs that Didn't Bite
- Presidential Primaries and the Collective Action Coordination Problem
- Recent Approaches to the Definition and Measurement of Compactness - w/ Hayden Goldberg
- Relative Ideology: Why Context Matters for a person's ideological ID
- Representation of Non-Eligible Resident Populations in Legislative Bodies - w/ Ocampo
- State Competitiveness and Pivotality in the U.S. Electoral College - w/ Zora Mihaley
- The Terminology Of Districting (this is long complete but never found a home)
- The Political Legacy of American Slavery Revisited
- Trump the wrestler and the 2024 grudge match
- Waiting For Godez

PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT & DIGITAL PROJECTS

- *Daily District (Better Know a District)* — Creator and Lead Developer (2026–present). A Wordle-style educational web game in which players identify all 435 U.S. House districts from their geography, designed to build civic and geographic literacy for a broad public audience.

TALKS (INVITED AND CONFERENCE)

- *Congressional Briefing on Redistricting Reform* — invited to Washington, D.C., to brief several dozen members of Congress. Problem Solvers Caucus, Hosted by Rep. Tom Suozzi and Rep. Brian Fitzpatrick. June 2026.
- *Reshaping Government: Possibilities and Perils. Congressional Redistricting Frenzy* - University of Pittsburgh, The Dick Thornburgh Forum for Law & Public Policy. Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania. June 4, 2026.

- *Redistricting: Drawing the Maps, Presentation and demonstration of how redistricting maps are drawn, including the data and inputs that go into making maps.* - National Conference of State Legislatures. Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania. May 29, 2026.
- *Racial Equality after Callais: Strategies for Implementing Electoral Systems Reform* - Harvard Law School (Charles Hamilton Houston Institute for Race & Justice). Cambridge, Massachusetts. April 16 - 17, 2026.
- *An Experiment on Optimal Campaigning Using a Simplified Seven State Electoral College* - Public Choice Society Annual Conference, San Antonio, Texas. March 14, 2026.
- *Mid-Decade Redistricting* - New York Law School, Hosted by Judge Michelle Childs. February 3, 2026.
- *What's the Story with Redistricting?* - Heinz School of Public Policy, Policy and Politics Group, September 24, 2025.
- *Mid-decade Redistricting* — New York Law School, Hosted by Jeff Wice, September 17, 2025.
- *Disinformation and the Fight for Democracy* — University of Pittsburgh, Hosted by Ralph L. Bangs, July 15, 2025.
- *Partisan & Racial Gerrymandering and the Voting Rights Act* — New York Law School, Hosted by Jeff Wice, February 19, 2025.
- *Gerrymandering and the Voting Rights Act: A Threat to Democracy?* — University of Pittsburgh, Hosted by Ralph L. Bangs, February 11, 2025.
- *Build a 2030 Redistricting Checklist* — National Conference of State Legislatures, NCSL Annual Summit, Louisville, KY, August 7, 2024.
- *NY Redistricting Conference: What Happened and What's Next?* — Keynote Speaker, New York Law School, June 18, 2024. [Website Keynote Remarks](#)
- *When Third Parties Matter* — Niskanen Center, Hosted by Matt Grossman, May 29, 2024. [Website](#)
- *Elections and Voting* — Sacramento State University, Hosted by Hallee Caron, March 25, 2024.
- *Elections Redistricting and Voting Rights* — New York Law School, Hosted by Jeff Wice, February 21, 2024.
- *The Issues Shaping Attitudes Around the Election* — New York University School of Journalism, Hosted by Eliza Griswold and SpotlightPA, February 19, 2024.
- *Redistricting* — Carnegie Mellon University Osher Class, Hosted by Randy Weinberg, October 23, 2023.

- *Power to the People* at “A Path Towards Equality” — Hosted by SpotlightPA, October 11, 2023. Website
- *Elections Redistricting and Voting Rights* — New York Law School, Hosted by Jeff Wice, October 4, 2023.
- *Federal Appellate Advocacy* — University of Pittsburgh School of Law, Hosted by Hon. D. Michael Fisher, September 26, 2023.
- *Pennsylvania Redistricting: Lessons Learned and Next Steps for Reform* — Hosted by Common Cause PA, League of Women Voters PA, NAACP PA, Committee of Seventy, FairDistricts PA, and Pennsylvania Voice, May 31, 2023.
- *Voting Rights and Election Law* — Touro Law School, Hosted by Judge Phil Solages, May 4, 2023.
- *Did a Libertarian Cost Trump the Election? A Q&A with Jonathan Cervas* - American Enterprise Institute. December 29, 2022. Website.
- *Remapping Democracy: Redistricting, Race, and Fair Elections in a Changing Legal Environment* — Government Law Review at Albany Law School, March 6, 2023. Website
- *Representation, Race, Redistricting* — CUNY Graduate School, Hosted by Keena Lipsitz and John Mollenkopf, November 17, 2022.
- *Voting Rights and Redistricting: Reshaping American Democracy* — New York Law School, Hosted by Jeff Wice, October 20, 2022.
- *Democracy Threatened: Will Your Vote Count?* — Great Issues Forum at Redeemer, October 12, 2022.
- *Contemporary Issues in Election Law* — New Hampshire Law School, Hosted by Kyle Kopko, October 7, 2022. Website
- *Voting Rights and Election Law* — Hofstra Law School, Hosted by Judge Phil Solages, September 12, 2022.
- *Measuring Compactness* — Pennsylvania Redistricting with Geographers: Communities of Interest Criteria and Beyond, American Association of Geographers.
- *Voting Rights and Elections* — University of Texas at Austin, Hosted by Beto O’Rourke, Spring 2021.
- *Tools for Identifying a Partisan Gerrymander* — Princeton University Wintersession.
- *2019 NCSL Capitol Forum (Legislative Options for Redistricting Post-conference)* — National Conference of State Legislatures.
- *Redrawing the Virginia Legislative Map: The Bethune-Hill Racial Gerrymandering Case* — Princeton University.

- *Triple Play: Election 2018, Census 2020, and Redistricting 2021* — University of Houston, Hobby School.
- *Representation of Non-Eligible Resident Populations in Legislative Bodies* — Center for the Study of Democracy Graduate Student Conference, UC Irvine.
- *Asymmetry in State Grant Distribution: Why Proximity to the State Capital Matters* — Western Political Science Association, San Diego, California.

SERVICE TO CARNEGIE MELLON

- Faculty Senate, CMIST Representative (2025–Present)
- Constitution Day, Committee Member (2025,2026)
- Democracy Day, Co-Chair (2025)
- Democracy Day, Committee Member (2024,2025,2026)
- Deeper Conversations, Speaker (2024): *Bridging the Divide: Understanding and Addressing Political Polarization in America* Website
- Speaker, Heinz School of Public Policy, Policy and Politics Group (2025)
- Committee, American Politics and Law Minor
- Committee, Undergraduate Honors Thesis
- Letters of Recommendations (9 in 2026, 6 in 2025, 8 in 2024, 10 in 2023)

SERVICE TO THE DISCIPLINE

Referee: *American Journal of Political Science*, *Political Analysis*, *Political Geography*, *Election Law Journal*, *Public Choice*, *Political Research Quarterly*

REFERENCES

BERNARD GROFMAN, UC IRVINE

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Fellow, American Academy of Arts and Sciences
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MARK NORDENBERG, UNIVERSITY OF PITTSBURGH

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